

Chapter 23-2

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Xu Qingya sat in the car and called Xu Qingzhu several times, but the phone was always turned off.

Thinking of Bai Weiwei, Liang Shi flipped through her contacts to find Zhao Xuning's contact information. Fortunately, she had been clever at the time and found Zhao Xuning's phone number from the hospital's information system, thinking that if she encountered an emergency situation in the future, she could contact her.

And now she really had encountered one.

She called Zhao Xuning, who seemed to be sleeping and sounded somewhat impatient: "Who is it?"

Liang Shi said gently: "It's Liang Shi."

Zhao Xuning paused, reining in some of that impatience, though her tone still wasn't particularly good: "What do you want so late at night?"

"I'm sorry," Liang Shi apologized first.

Zhao Xuning was straightforward: "If you have something to say, say it. If not, I'm hanging up."

"I do," Liang Shi said. "Bai Weiwei is at Huayue International right now."

"Just her alone?" Zhao Xuning said. "She goes there often."

"Playing games with people," Liang Shi explained. "I don't know why, but she also called Xu Qingzhu to go. Someone just sent me photos—they're both drunk."

"Damn." Zhao Xuning cursed under her breath. "These inhuman bastards."

"Huh?" Liang Shi had just turned a corner, and Zhao Xuning spoke too quietly for her to hear clearly, so she asked: "What did you say?"

Zhao Xuning said irritably: "Nothing."

There were rustling sounds from the other end of the phone, probably from changing clothes.

"Which specific private room number," Zhao Xuning said. "I'm close to Huayue International, I'll go over first."

"..."

Liang Shi was confused and said rather embarrassedly: "I didn't ask."

Zhao Xuning: "...?"

On this end of the phone, Liang Shi could imagine how Zhao Xuning wanted to curse her—What the fuck, you don't even know the room number and you're calling me?

Liang Shi coughed lightly: "I'll call and ask now."

She hung up and called that number from before.

But that number was no longer answering.

At the same time, Zhao Xuning sent a text: 【Show me the photos.】

Liang Shi had Xu Qingya forward the photos to her.

After Xu Qingya sent them, she zoomed in on the photos to look, and almost simultaneously with Zhao Xuning, recognized: "This is 7588."

Zhao Xuning's text also came: she also guessed it was 7588.

Liang Shi was surprised—they could recognize it from this?

"How did you recognize it?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingya turned off her phone screen and put her phone back in the storage compartment: "Every private room at Huayue International has some distinctive items or architecture. Rooms one through twelve are based on the zodiac animals, and each room is decorated according to the zodiac theme, with elements related to the zodiac animals. The later numbered rooms are random. 7588's symbol is deer—there are deer on the table in the photo, the light and shadows projected on the wall are also deer, and there's a deer ornament in the bottom right corner."

"I see." Liang Shi hadn't expected that even a private room would have so many details.

Even though she wasn't inexperienced with the world, she was still a bit surprised.

Someone who could come up with this kind of decoration style was definitely no ordinary person.

"But this private room..." Xu Qingya frowned and paused.

Liang Shi noticed something off in her tone: "What's wrong?"

"Drive faster," Xu Qingya grabbed the handle on the side of the car. "My sister is in danger."

Liang Shi: "...What do you mean?"

Xu Qingya's eyes were already red. She closed her eyes and said in a choked voice: "After ten o'clock, the inhibitors¹ will lose their effect on everyone in this private room."

Liang Shi: "?"

"They'll enter heat, and it's different from normal heat periods," Xu Qingya said. "I heard people say that the last drink they have before ten o'clock will have something in it..."

This kind of drug was something she felt embarrassed to mention.

So she deliberately avoided it: "After ten o'clock, this private room will gradually become a paradise² for Alphas and Omegas to revel, and people generally call it the Tender Village³."

"This private room doesn't open easily, and normally it only operates until ten o'clock," Xu Qingya said.

"Then it should be fine, right?" Liang Shi said. "Why would they even advertise this gimmick?"

"But it doesn't close on Saturday nights," Xu Qingya let out a light breath, almost crying from anger. "Who the hell is this? Are they crazy? Bringing Xu Qingzhu to that kind of place? Damn it, if I find out who it was, I'll kill them!"

Xu Qingya's tone was agitated, and by the end of her words, her voice was already trembling.

A teenage girl had never experienced such a major incident before, and just thinking about it was terrifying.

She clenched her fists and pleaded: "Sister Liang, please hurry, okay? If Xu Qingzhu experiences something like this, she'll definitely go insane."

In her urgency, she couldn't even be bothered to call her "sister" anymore.

"When she's drunk, her senses become more sensitive. If she's forced..." Xu Qingya already felt like she was suffocating, her heart felt like someone had grabbed it and punched it hard. She couldn't help but cry out: "She has PTSD⁴!"

Liang Shi was infected by this sorrowful emotion.

She pressed the gas pedal to the floor. There wasn't much traffic on the road, and on the empty road, the white Porsche sped past like lightning. Passersby could only catch a glimpse of the car's tail in the blink of an eye.

"Don't worry," Liang Shi tried to maintain her composure to comfort Xu Qingya. "We'll make it in time. Your sister will be fine."

"I hope so," Xu Qingya said through gritted teeth. "If I find out who brought her there, I'll hack them to pieces."

Liang Shi: "..."

Who would have thought—she's actually a sister-protecting maniac.

Liang Shi suddenly felt a chill on the back of her neck.

If Xu Qingya found out about the things the original owner had done, she'd probably be the first to grab a knife and enter the villa.

And give her a stab when she wasn't paying attention.

Liang Shi shrank her neck, but her foot movements didn't slack off at all.

Just thinking that Xu Qingzhu might have a PTSD episode made her heart ache.

The scene of Xu Qingzhu's PTSD episode that day was still vivid in her mind—her screams were like those of a helpless, lost child.

Liang Shi really couldn't bear it.

It was hard to find parking near Huayue International.

But Liang Shi couldn't care about that much anymore. She parked the car directly at the entrance and hurriedly got out, just as Zhao Xuning, who had rushed over, arrived.

Xu Qingya had already run toward the entrance.

But she was stopped by security at the door.

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning didn't exchange pleasantries either, skipping all the necessary steps of meeting and directly exchanged a glance to understand each other's meaning.

Footnotes:

¹ Inhibitors: In ABO dynamics, medications used to suppress or control pheromones and heat/rut cycles

² Paradise: A place of indulgence and pleasure

³ Tender Village: A euphemistic term for a place of sensual pleasure or debauchery

⁴ PTSD: Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder, a mental health condition triggered by experiencing or witnessing a traumatic event